

Sample



Standard Operating Procedure: Data Center Physical Security

Quasar Inc.

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to define the protocols for ensuring physical security at the data center. The data center hosts critical infrastructure that supports business operations and stores sensitive data. This SOP aims to prevent unauthorized access, theft, tampering, and physical damage to the facility, equipment, and data. The procedure helps ensure compliance with organizational policies and relevant security standards.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all personnel who work in or visit the data center, including employees, third-party contractors, and guests. It covers access control, surveillance, visitor management, emergency response, and regular security checks. These procedures are applicable to all data center locations managed by the organization.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Data Center Manager:** Oversees enforcement of all physical security policies. Responsible for reviewing access logs, approving access requests, and coordinating with security personnel.
- **Security Personnel:** Stationed at all primary access points to the data center. Responsible for monitoring CCTV, verifying identification, controlling access, and conducting patrols.
- **IT Staff and Contractors:** Must follow all access protocols. Access is role-based and must be requested through the designated access request system.
- **Visitors:** Must be registered in advance, signed in on arrival, wear visitor badges, and always remain under escort.

4. Access Control Procedures

4.1 Authorization

Access to the data center is restricted to approved personnel only. Employees and contractors must submit an access request form specifying the purpose and duration of access. Requests must be approved by the Data Center Manager or designated authority.

4.2 Access Systems

Access control is managed through a two-factor authentication system consisting of:

- **Access Cards:** Issued to approved individuals and configured with role-based permissions.
- **Biometric Scanners:** Fingerprint or retina scanners used to verify identity.

4.3 Badge Policy

All personnel must wear a company-issued photo ID badge while on site. Visitor badges are temporary, clearly marked, and must be surrendered upon exit.

5. Entry and Exit Logging

All entries and exits are logged via the access control system. These logs are reviewed weekly by the Data Center Manager to detect anomalies or unauthorized access attempts. In the event of suspicious activity, logs are escalated to the security team for investigation.

6. Visitor Management

Visitors are permitted only with prior approval. The host must submit a request 24 hours in advance, including the visitor's full name, company, reason for visit, and duration.

Upon arrival:

- Visitors must present valid government-issued identification.
- A visitor badge is issued at the security desk.
- The host must escort the visitor at all times inside the facility.
- Visitors must sign out before leaving.

7. Surveillance and Monitoring

The facility is under continuous surveillance using CCTV systems, which cover all entrances, exits, and sensitive areas.

- All footage is recorded and retained for at least 90 days.
- Cameras must be tested weekly for functionality.
- Motion sensors and alarm systems are installed in restricted zones.

Surveillance data is confidential and accessible only to authorized security and management personnel.

8. Physical Security Inspections

Routine inspections are conducted to ensure all security mechanisms are operational:

- Daily checks by on-site security personnel to verify locks, doors, and alarm systems.
- Weekly inspections of surveillance equipment and access control systems.
- Quarterly audits by security and IT management to assess compliance with this SOP.

All inspection results must be documented and reviewed by the Data Center Manager.

9. Emergency Procedures

In the event of an emergency such as fire, break-in, or unauthorized access:

- Trigger the emergency lockdown protocol to restrict further entry or exit.
- Contact local emergency services and notify internal security response teams.
- Evacuate personnel if required, using clearly marked emergency exits.
- Conduct a post-incident review and update SOPs if needed.

Emergency drills must be conducted semi-annually to ensure staff preparedness.

10. Compliance and Review

Compliance with this SOP is mandatory. Non-compliance may result in access revocation, disciplinary action, or legal consequences. This SOP is to be reviewed annually or immediately following any security incident or policy change.

11. References

- ISO/IEC 27001: Information Security Management Standard
- NIST SP 800-53: Security and Privacy Controls
- Organization's Information Security Policy
- Data Center Access Request Procedure